

Laboratory Terminology Glossary

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Purpose

A reference glossary of common terms used across laboratory screens, workflows, and documentation.

Terms

Term	Definition
Specimen	A biological sample collected for laboratory testing.
Reference Range	The expected range of values for a test result in a healthy population.
Critical Value	A result so far outside the reference range that it requires immediate notification.
Hemolysis	The breakdown of red blood cells, which can affect specimen quality.
Chain of Custody	Documentation tracking a specimen from collection through result reporting.
Point-of-Care Testing	Testing performed at or near the site of patient care rather than in a central lab.
Turnaround Time	The time elapsed from specimen collection to result availability.
Aliquot	A portion of a specimen set aside for a specific test.
Quality Control	Procedures used to verify the accuracy and reliability of test results.
Positive Patient Identification	Confirming a patient's identity using at least two identifiers before specimen collection.
Centrifugation	A process using rotational force to separate specimen components.
Panel	A group of related tests ordered and resulted together.
Culture	A laboratory method for growing and identifying microorganisms from a specimen.
Assay	A laboratory procedure used to measure the presence or concentration of a substance.
Result Verification	Review and approval of a test result before it is released to the patient's record.

Reference Visual (Synthetic)

